

Play Coupons

and gift-reveal cards

16 play coupons a grown-up can give a child, plus cards that turn any gift of play into a surprise.



16

PLAY COUPONS

12

NEED NOTHING TO BUY

3

GIFT-REVEAL CARDS

8

BLANK COUPONS + A
COVER

Prep: about 10 minutes to print, cut on straight lines and staple. No cutting? Give the whole coupon page, folded like a letter.



A Blanket Fort



A Kitchen Dance
Party



Pancake Helper



A Walk Where
You Lead



Build Anything



Bubble Time



A Sock Puppet
Show



A Living-Room
Picnic

How to give a gift of play

A coupon is a promise to play: time together, not a thing to buy. It takes about 2 minutes to set up and works as a gift on its own or tucked in with another gift.

1 • Pick

Choose 3–6 coupons that suit your child's age. Each shows a starting age. Fill in a blank one with a play your family already loves.

2 • Wrap

Cut them out, add the coupon-book cover and staple the stack at the left edge. Or fold the whole page like a letter.

3 • Reveal

Use the fold card or a reveal card to say what's inside. Your child hands you a coupon when they want to play it.

Talk while you play

Pause and wait

Say a little, then stop. A look, a sound or a wiggle is an answer.

"Ready, set... (wait) roll!"

Say what you see

Put words to what your child is doing, right as it happens.

"Big bubble... POP!"

Offer a choice

Hold up two things and wait. Pointing counts as an answer.

"Left or right?"



Most children love 2–3 of these and ask for them again and again. Say yes as often as you can, and let the rest wait. **Talk, sing and read in the language you know best.** A sign, a point or a device tap counts as communicating.

Why coupons?

Young children learn in back-and-forth moments with the people who love them. A coupon puts one of those moments on the calendar. It adds play; it never takes anything away.

A few house rules

Coupons never expire and are never taken back. They are never traded for screen time or sweets, and they are never a reward for good behavior. They are just for fun.

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Play coupons for ages 1-5

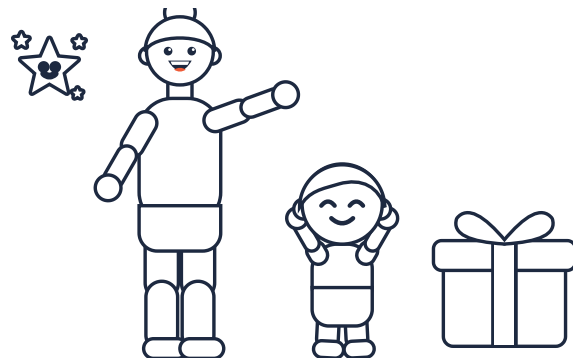


✂ CUT ON THE OUTER LINE · FOLD HERE · WRITE YOUR MESSAGE INSIDE

A GIFT FOR YOU

A gift of play

Time together, one coupon at a time.



For

From

SURPRISE!

Inside is...



For

From

✂ CUT ON THE DASHED LINES

SURPRISE!

Inside is...



For

From

Cut, stack and staple, or give the whole page

✂ CUT ON THE DASHED LINES • GROWN-UP KEEPS THE PIECES



No. 1

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

A Blanket Fort

We build a fort together and read a book inside it.

💬 "Knock, knock! Who lives here?"

🟢 from 18 mo 🧑 With a grown-up
🟢 Nothing to buy



No. 2

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

A Kitchen Dance Party

You pick three songs and we dance until the last one ends.

💬 "Fast... slow... FREEZE!"

🟢 from 1 yr 🧑 With a grown-up
🟢 Nothing to buy



No. 3

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

Pancake Helper

You measure, pour and stir. The grown-up does the stove.

💬 "Pour... stir, stir... (wait) more?"

★ from 30 mo 🧑 With a grown-up
🔒 Needs: Pancake things



No. 4

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

A Walk Where You Lead

You choose which way we turn at every corner.

💬 "Left or right? (wait) You choose!"

🟢 from 1 yr 🧑 With a grown-up
🟢 Nothing to buy



No. 5

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

Build Anything

We build whatever you say: a tower, a house, a zoo.

💬 "Up, up, up... CRASH!"

🟢 from 18 mo 🧑 With a grown-up
🟢 Nothing to buy



No. 6

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

Bubble Time

The grown-up blows bubbles and you chase, clap and pop them.

💬 "Big bubble... (wait) POP!"

🟢 from 1 yr 🧑 With a grown-up
🔒 Needs: Bubble mix and a wand



No. 7

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

A Sock Puppet Show

We make sock puppets and put on a show behind the sofa.

💬 "Hello! (wait) What's your name?"

★ from 2 yrs 🧑 With a grown-up
🟢 Nothing to buy



No. 8

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

A Living-Room Picnic

We spread a blanket on the floor and have a picnic with your toys.

💬 "Teddy wants... (wait) a cracker?"

🟢 from 18 mo 🧑 With a grown-up
🟢 Nothing to buy

Cut, stack and staple, or give the whole page

✂ CUT ON THE DASHED LINES • GROWN-UP KEEPS THE PIECES



No. 9

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

Paint Together

We each paint a picture, then swap and add to each other's.

💬 "What color next? (wait) Red?"

★ from 2 yrs 👤 With a grown-up
📦 Needs: Paper



No. 10

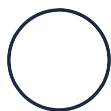
PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

Bake Together

You pour, stir and shape. The grown-up does the oven.

💬 "Roll, roll... squash!"

🟠 from 3 yrs 👤 With a grown-up
📦 Needs: A simple recipe



No. 11

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

A Ball Game

We roll, kick and throw a ball at the park or down the hall.

💬 "Ready, set... (wait) roll!"

🟢 from 1 yr 👤 With a grown-up
📦 Nothing to buy



No. 12

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

A Box Car

We turn a big box into a car, draw the wheels and go for a drive.

💬 "Beep beep! Where are we going?"

★ from 30 mo 👤 With a grown-up
📦 Nothing to buy



No. 13

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

A Treasure Hunt

The grown-up hides a toy and draws a map. You follow it to the treasure.

💬 "Warmer... warmer... you found it!"

★ from 30 mo 👤 With a grown-up
📦 Nothing to buy



No. 14

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

A Dress-Up Parade

We dress up in grown-up clothes and march in a parade.

💬 "Who are you today?"

★ from 2 yrs 👤 With a grown-up
📦 Nothing to buy



No. 15

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

One Extra Story

At bedtime you get one more story. You choose the book.

💬 "What happens next? (wait)"

🟢 from 1 yr 👤 With a grown-up
📦 Nothing to buy



No. 16

PLAY COUPON • GOOD FOR

You Choose the Play

You choose any play and the grown-up joins in, all the way.

💬 "Show me how! (wait)"

★ from 2 yrs 👤 With a grown-up
📦 Nothing to buy

Cut, stack and staple, or give the whole page

CUT ON THE DASHED LINES · GROWN-UP KEEPS THE PIECES

A BOOK OF

Play Coupons

For _____

From _____





PLAY COUPON · GOOD FOR

To _____ From _____



PLAY COUPON · GOOD FOR

To _____ From _____



PLAY COUPON · GOOD FOR

To _____ From _____



PLAY COUPON · GOOD FOR

To _____ From _____



PLAY COUPON · GOOD FOR

To _____ From _____



PLAY COUPON · GOOD FOR

To _____ From _____



PLAY COUPON · GOOD FOR

To _____ From _____

 Play Before Pixels

Gift-Reveal Cards and Play Coupons · page 7 of 11 · Version 1.0 · September 2026
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Easier, harder, a 2-minute version and a safety line for every coupon



1. A Blanket Fort from 18 mo

From 18 mo · Blankets, chairs, a book

- ✓ **Easier:** One blanket over the table.
- ⬆ **Harder:** Add a door, a window and a sign.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** Blanket over your knees; one page of a book.
- ✓ **Safety:** Nothing heavy on top; no cords or clips holding the blankets. Keep one side open.



2. A Kitchen Dance Party from 1 yr

From 12 mo · Any music, or your singing

- ✓ **Easier:** Hold your baby and sway.
- ⬆ **Harder:** Take turns leading the moves.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** One song, one twirl.
- ✓ **Safety:** Clear the floor first. Bare feet or grippy socks.



3. Pancake Helper from 30 mo

From 30 mo · Pancake things, a bowl, a spoon

- ✓ **Easier:** You stir; the grown-up pours.
- ⬆ **Harder:** Count the spoonfuls and read the steps together.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** Stir the bowl ten times together.
- ✓ **Safety:** Only the grown-up works at the stove and flips. Hot pan stays at the back. Check allergies.



4. A Walk Where You Lead from 1 yr

From 12 mo · Shoes and coats

- ✓ **Easier:** Stroller or carrier walk; name what you see.
- ⬆ **Harder:** Draw a map of where we went.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** Once around the block, or to the window and back.
- ✓ **Safety:** Hold hands near roads. Look, don't taste: berries, nuts and leaves stay out of mouths.



5. Build Anything from 18 mo

From 18 mo · Blocks, boxes or cushions

- ✓ **Easier:** Stack three, knock them down.
- ⬆ **Harder:** Build a bridge a toy can drive under.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** One tower, one crash.
- ✓ **Safety:** Under 3: only blocks too big to fit through a toilet-paper tube. Keep towers below chest height.



6. Bubble Time from 1 yr

From 12 mo · Bubble mix and a wand

- ✓ **Easier:** Pop them with one finger.
- ⬆ **Harder:** Blow your own and count them.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** Ten bubbles, ten pops.
- ✓ **Safety:** A grown-up blows bubbles for children under 3. Wipe up spills so no one slips. Nobody drinks the mix.



7. A Sock Puppet Show from 2 yrs

From 24 mo · Clean socks, a sofa

- ✓ **Easier:** The grown-up's puppet says hello and tickles.
- ⬆ **Harder:** Your puppet tells a story with a start and an end.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** One sock, one "Hello!"
- ✓ **Safety:** Socks with nothing sewn or glued on: no buttons, beads or pom-poms.



8. A Living-Room Picnic from 18 mo

From 18 mo · A blanket, a snack

- ✓ **Easier:** One snack, one toy guest.
- ⬆ **Harder:** Plan the menu and set a place for every guest.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** Snack on a towel on the floor.
- ✓ **Safety:** Soft food cut small, eaten sitting down. No whole grapes, nuts, popcorn or hard candy for little ones.

Easier, harder, a 2-minute version and a safety line for every coupon



9. Paint Together ★ from 2 yrs

👤 From 24 mo · 📦 Paper, washable paint, a brush

- ✓ **Easier:** Water painting on a fence or a chalkboard.
- ⬆️ **Harder:** Paint a picture of our day.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** Three brush strokes each.
- ✓ **Safety:** Washable, non-food paint with a grown-up beside. An old shirt as a smock.



10. Bake Together 🔴 from 3 yrs

👤 From 36 mo · 📦 A simple recipe

- ✓ **Easier:** You press the shapes; the grown-up does the rest.
- ⬆️ **Harder:** Read the recipe pictures and count the scoops.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** Squash one ball of dough together.
- ✓ **Safety:** Only the grown-up uses the oven and hot trays. No tasting raw dough. Check allergies.



11. A Ball Game 🟢 from 1 yr

👤 From 12 mo · 📦 A soft ball

- ✓ **Easier:** Sit facing each other and roll it back and forth.
- ⬆️ **Harder:** Kick it between two shoes: a goal!
- ⌚ **2-minute:** Five rolls back and forth.
- ✓ **Safety:** A soft ball too big to fit through a toilet-paper tube. Play away from roads and stairs.



12. A Box Car ★ from 30 mo

👤 From 30 mo · 📦 A big cardboard box, crayons

- ✓ **Easier:** Sit in the box; the grown-up pushes gently.
- ⬆️ **Harder:** Add lights, a number plate and a map.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** Sit in the box and say "Beep beep!"
- ✓ **Safety:** Take out staples and loose tape first. Push slowly on flat floors only.



13. A Treasure Hunt ★ from 30 mo

👤 From 30 mo · 📦 A toy to hide, paper

- ✓ **Easier:** Hide it half showing, close by.
- ⬆️ **Harder:** Three clues, one after another.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** Hide it under a cushion right beside you.
- ✓ **Safety:** Hide only in safe, easy spots: never up high, near stairs or near cleaning things.



14. A Dress-Up Parade ★ from 2 yrs

👤 From 24 mo · 📦 Hats, shirts, shoes

- ✓ **Easier:** Just hats: on, off, on again.
- ⬆️ **Harder:** Make a costume and tell us who you are.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** One hat each and one march around the room.
- ✓ **Safety:** No scarves, ties, belts or cords. Take small parts off anything a child under 3 wears.



15. One Extra Story 🟢 from 1 yr

👤 From 12 mo · 📦 Any book

- ✓ **Easier:** Look at the pictures and name what you see.
- ⬆️ **Harder:** You tell the story from the pictures.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** One page, one cuddle.
- ✓ **Safety:** A board book for little ones who still mouth pages.



16. You Choose the Play ★ from 2 yrs

👤 From 24 mo · 📦 Whatever the play needs

- ✓ **Easier:** Pick between two plays.
- ⬆️ **Harder:** Plan the play and explain the rules.
- ⌚ **2-minute:** Pick a 2-minute play.
- ✓ **Safety:** Grown-up checks the chosen play is safe for your child's age before starting.

Good to know

Every coupon follows these rules, and the coupon key has a safety line for each one. You know your child best: skip or change anything that doesn't suit them.



A grown-up plays too

Every coupon is for a child and a grown-up together.



The toilet-paper tube test

For children under 3, anything that fits through a toilet-paper tube (about 1.25 in or 3.2 cm) stays out of reach.



Food and allergies

Soft food cut small, eaten sitting down. No whole grapes, nuts, popcorn or hard candy for little ones.



No cords, no balloons

No cords, ribbons, scarves or ties left with a child. No balloons for children under 8.

Quick answers

Which file do I print?

Pick one: US Letter or A4, color or low-ink. Every file has the same 11 pages. Print at "Actual size" or 100%.

Which pages?

Page 3 (fold card), 4 (reveal cards), 5–6 (coupons) and 7 (blank coupons and the cover). Pages 2 and 8–9 are for you.

What paper?

Card stock makes sturdy coupons; plain paper works. Print the fold card on its own sheet and leave the back blank for your message.

Can I type in it?

Yes, with a free PDF reader: the For and From lines, the reveal-card lines and the blank coupons. Pictures and colors can't be changed.

What age is it for?

Ages 1–5. Every coupon shows a starting age in months. Pick the ones that fit; the coupon key has an easier version of each.

Can I share it?

Your license covers one household, plus the child you give the coupons to. Please don't share the files.

These are everyday play ideas for families, not medical or developmental advice. Questions about your child's growth or health? Your child's doctor is a good place to start.

More from Play Before Pixels

Find them all at playbeforepixels.com.



Ages 1–5 Instant Gift Bundle

The busy book, family kit pages and two play-card sets in one download, with these coupons inside.



Toddler Busy Book

74 activities for ages 1–5: matching, colors, shapes, pretend play and mazes.



52 Play & Talk Cards

One play and one talk tip on every card, for ages 0–5.



FOR GROWN-UPS

Free printable: Five 5-Minute Plays

Scan for the free printable and the monthly “3 plays for your child’s age” email. We ask only for your email and, if you like, your child’s birth month and year. Never names.

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Gift-Reveal Cards and Play Coupons, ages 1–5. Version 1.0 · September 2026. Everyday play ideas for families, not medical or developmental advice. Every play follows our published safety rules; a grown-up is always there.

Personal license: one household, plus the child you give the coupons to. Please don’t resell or share the files.

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